

What is Python?

Python is a text-based programming language. It takes a bit longer to learn than Scratch, but can be used to do much more.

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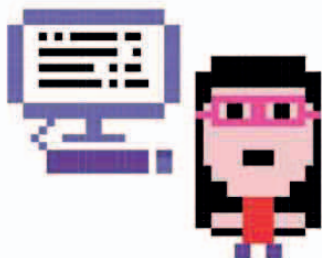
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commands

A useful language

Python is a versatile language that can be used to make many different types of programs, from word processing to web browsers. Here are a few great reasons to learn Python.

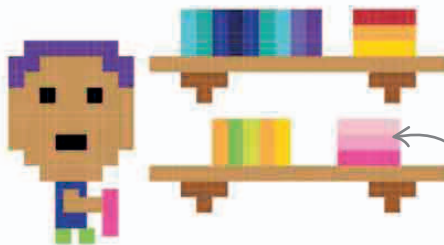
1 Easy to learn and use

Python programs are written in a simple language. The code is quite easy to read and write, compared to many other programming languages.



2 Contains ready-to-use code

Python contains libraries of preprogrammed code that you can use in your programs. It makes it easier to write complex programs quickly.



Python contains lots of programs you can use and build on

3 Useful for big organizations

Python is powerful. It can be used to write real-world programs. It is used by Google, NASA, and Pixar, among others.



EXPERT TIPS

Getting started

Before learning how to program in Python, it's useful to get familiar with how it works. The next few pages will teach you how to:

Install Python: Python is free, but you'll have to install it yourself (see pp.88–91).

Use the interface: Make a simple program and save it on the computer.

Experiment: Try some simple programs to see how they work.